UNIVERSITY OF NORTH CAROLINA
CHARLOTTE

WEEK - 15 AI DIGEST

HIGHER EDUCATION

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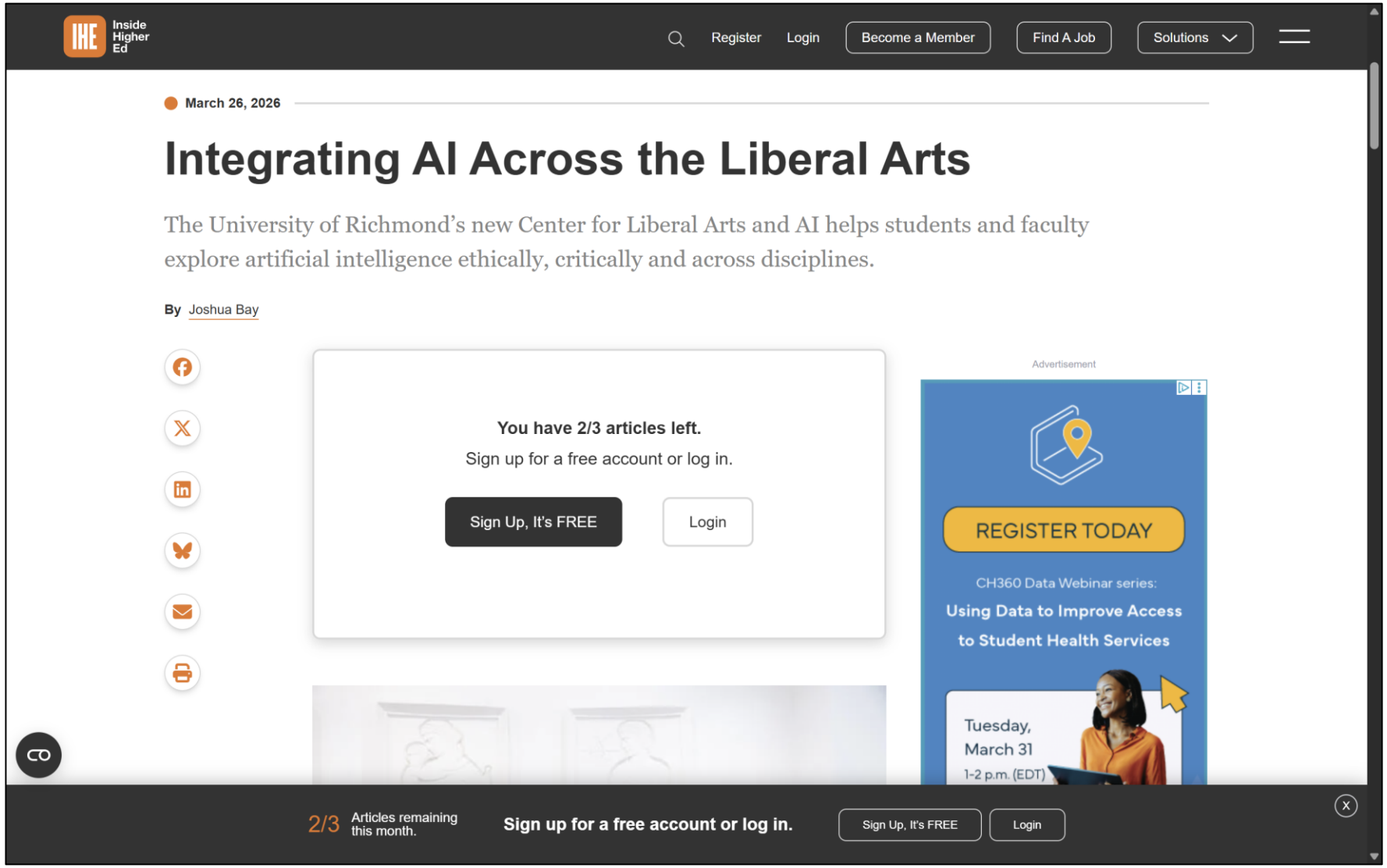
TITLE & LINK OF THE ARTICLE: INTEGRATING AI ACROSS THE LIBERAL ARTS

Screenshot of the Headline



MAIN FINDINGS AND ARGUMENTS

- The University of Richmond has launched the Center for Liberal Arts and AI (CLAAI), a cross-campus initiative designed to embed AI into the student experience in ways that are both practical and critically informed. The center partners with the Associated Colleges of the South, bringing together 23 faculty fellows from regional institutions including Washington and Lee University and Rhodes College to explore pressing social, cultural, and legal questions surrounding AI. Center director Lauren Tilton argues that being a critical thinker in a liberal arts context means being both innovative with new technologies and an informed, ethical user of them. A key shift in Richmond's philosophy is moving the conversation about AI beyond academic integrity and cheating, instead approaching student AI use with empathy, trust, and collaboration. Richmond's model mirrors broader higher education trends, with institutions like Cornell developing AI critical thinking modules and Bryn Mawr College transforming libraries into AI literacy sandboxes.

BROADER IMPLICATIONS FOR SOCIETY

- Richmond's initiative reflects a growing societal recognition that AI fluency is no longer optional — it is becoming woven into the fabric of academic and professional life. By grounding AI integration within humanistic values and critical inquiry, the university challenges the notion that AI is purely a technical concern belonging to STEM fields. The article signals a cultural shift: rather than institutions reacting to AI with fear or blanket restrictions, leading universities are proactively building frameworks that teach students *when* and *how* to use AI responsibly, not just that they can. This has broad societal implications — as AI becomes embedded across industries, the workforce of the future will need graduates who can think critically about AI outputs, understand its historical context, and evaluate its ethical consequences. Richmond's collaborative, trust-based approach to student AI use also models a healthier social dynamic between institutions and the communities they serve.

RELEVANCE OR POTENTIAL INFLUENCE ON THE CONSTRUCTION INDUSTRY

- The construction industry is increasingly adopting AI tools for project scheduling, cost estimation, generative design, safety monitoring, and Building Information Modeling (BIM). However, the effective and responsible use of these tools requires more than technical ability — it demands the kind of critical, ethical judgment that programs like CLAAI are cultivating. As Tilton notes, understanding a technology means knowing both when to use it and when not to — a distinction that is especially consequential in construction, where AI-driven errors can result in safety hazards, budget overruns, or structural failures. Universities that produce graduates trained to critically evaluate AI tools, rather than blindly rely on them, will directly supply the construction industry with a more capable and discerning workforce. Furthermore, Richmond's emphasis on cross-disciplinary AI literacy — spanning humanities, social sciences, and professional fields — mirrors the increasingly interdisciplinary nature of modern construction management, where technical decisions must account for legal, ethical, and community dimensions.

THANK YOU